

SAT Reading & Writing

Words in Context 3

Question #	ID		Answer
3.1	22a41819	Rejecting the premise that the literary magazine <i>Ebony and Topaz</i> (1927) should present a unified vision of Black American identity, editor Charles S. Johnson fostered his contributors' diverse perspectives by promoting their authorial autonomy. Johnson's self-effacement diverged from the editorial stances of W.E.B. Du Bois and Alain Locke, whose decisions for their publications were more _____. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. proficient B. dogmatic C. ambiguous D. unpretentious	B
3.2	5e57efec	Economist Marco Castillo and colleagues showed that nuisance costs—the time and effort people must spend to make donations—reduce charitable giving. Charities can mitigate this effect by compensating donors for nuisance costs, but those costs, though variable, are largely _____ donation size, so charities that compensate donors will likely favor attracting a few large donors over many small donors. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. supplemental to B. predictive of C. independent of D. subsumed in	C
3.3	e459076b	The following text is adapted from George Eliot's 1871–72 novel <i>Middlemarch</i>. [Mr. Brooke] had travelled in his younger years, and was held in this part of the country to have <u>contracted</u> a too rambling habit of mind. Mr. Brooke's conclusions were as difficult to predict as the weather. As used in the text, what does the word “contracted” most nearly mean? A. Restricted B. Described C. Developed D. Settled	C
3.4	76e4c51d	The güiro, a musical instrument traditionally made from a dried and hollowed gourd, is thought to have originated with the Taíno people of Puerto Rico. Players use a wooden stick to scrape along ridges cut into the side of the gourd, creating sounds that are highly _____: the sounds produced by güiros can differ based on the distance between the ridges, the types of strokes the player uses, and the thickness of the gourd. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. overlooked B. powerful C. routine D. variable	D
3.5	54804e10	While scholars believe many Mesoamerican cities influenced each other, direct evidence of such influence is difficult to ascertain. However, recent excavations in a sector of Tikal (Guatemala) unearthed a citadel that shows _____ Teotihuacán (Mexico) architecture—including a near replica of a famed Teotihuacán temple—providing tangible evidence of outside influence in portions of Tikal. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. refinements of B. precursors of C. commonalities with D. animosities toward	C

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3.6	c14daa3c	Close analysis of the painting <i>Girl with a Flute</i>, long attributed to the seventeenth-century Dutch painter Johannes Vermeer, has revealed subtle deviations from the artist's signature techniques. These variations suggest that the work may be that of a student under Vermeer's tutelage—potentially _____ our understanding of Vermeer as a solitary artist. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. negating B. prefiguring C. entrenching D. substantiating	A
3.7	e4f312c5	While most animals are incapable of passing somatic mutations—genetic alterations that arise in an organism's nonreproductive cells—on to their offspring, elkhorn coral (<i>Acropora palmata</i>) presents an intriguing _____. In a 2022 study, researchers found that elkhorn coral produced offspring that inherited somatic mutations from a parent. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. hypothesis B. affinity C. anomaly D. corroboration	C
3.8	3d658a5a	Some foraging models predict that the distance bees travel when foraging will decline as floral density increases, but biologists Shalene Jha and Claire Kremen showed that bees' behavior is inconsistent with this prediction if flowers in dense patches are _____. Bees will forage beyond patches of low species richness to acquire multiple resource types. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. depleted B. homogeneous C. immature D. dispersed	B
3.9	3f753a8e	Investigating whether shared false visual memories—specific but inaccurate and widely held recollections of images such as product logos—are caused by people's previous _____ incorrect renditions of the images, researchers Deepasri Prasad and Wilma Bainbridge found that, in fact, such memories are often not explained by familiarity with erroneous versions of the images. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. compliance with B. exposure to C. criteria for D. forfeiture of	B
3.10	e8fb0744	As an undergraduate researcher in anthropology, Jennifer C. Chen contributed to a groundbreaking study challenging the accepted view that among prehistoric peoples, female participation in hunting was _____. The research team's review of data from late Pleistocene and early Holocene burials in the Americas revealed that, in fact, as many as half of the hunters in those populations were female. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. inevitable B. satisfactory C. negligible D. commonplace	C

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3.11	9b22bf7b	The following text is from the 1989 novel <i>The Ancient Child</i> by Kiowa writer N. Scott Momaday. The main character has achieved tremendous commercial success as a painter. More and more often he was asked to compromise his art or himself in one way or another, and more often than not he did so, for he was inclined to be passive and naïve; it was difficult for him to say no. Those who exhibited his work, who praised and purchased it, and who demanded its proliferation began to <u>determine</u> it. ©1989 by N. Scott Momaday As used in the text, what does the word “determine” most nearly mean? A. Conclude B. Dictate C. Evaluate D. Select	B
3.12	5dce6cab	Given that the conditions in binary star systems should make planetary formation nearly impossible, it’s not surprising that the existence of planets in such systems has lacked _____ explanation. Roman Rafikov and Kedron Silsbee shed light on the subject when they used modeling to determine a complex set of factors that could support planets’ development. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. a discernible B. a straightforward C. an inconclusive D. an unbiased	B
3.13	e7d37666	It is by no means _____ to recognize the influence of Dutch painter Hieronymus Bosch on Ali Banisadr’s paintings; indeed, Banisadr himself cites Bosch as an inspiration. However, some scholars have suggested that the ancient Mesopotamian poem <i>Epic of Gilgamesh</i> may have had a far greater impact on Banisadr’s work. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. substantial B. satisfying C. unimportant D. appropriate	C
3.14	f83f0aab	Some scientists have suggested that mammals in the Mesozoic era were not a very _____ group, but paleontologist Zhe-Xi Luo’s research suggests that early mammals living in the shadow of dinosaurs weren’t all ground-dwelling insectivores. Fossils of various plant-eating mammals have been found in China, including species like <i>Vilevolodon diplomylos</i>, which Luo says could glide like a flying squirrel. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. predatory B. obscure C. diverse D. localized	C

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3.15 3566120b

The following text is adapted from Oscar Wilde's 1895 play *The Importance of Being Earnest*.

CECILY: Have we got to part?

ALGERNON: I am afraid so. It's a very painful parting.

CECILY: It is always painful to part from people whom one has known for a very brief space of time. The absence of old friends one can endure with equanimity. But even a momentary separation from anyone to whom one has just been introduced is almost unbearable.

As used in the text, what does the word "endure" most nearly mean?

- A. Regret
- B. Persist
- C. Tolerate
- D. Encourage

C

3.16 a60b0004

Scholarly discussions of gender in Shakespeare's comedies often celebrate the rebellion of the playwright's characters against the rigid expectations _____ by Elizabethan society. Most of the comedies end in marriage, with characters returning to their socially dictated gender roles after previously defying them, but there are some notable exceptions.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A. interjected
- B. committed
- C. illustrated
- D. prescribed

D

3.17 4fa7e50e

According to a US tax policy expert, state taxes are _____ other factors when considering an interstate move. Even significant differences in state taxation have almost no effect on most people's decisions, while differences in employment opportunities, housing availability, and climate are strong influences.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A. consistent with
- B. representative of
- C. overshadowed by
- D. irrelevant to

C

3.18 abcd0009

Environmental engineer Florentino De la Cruz has shown that it is misleading to treat municipal solid waste (MSW) as _____ when determining MSW decay rates. Grass in MSW decays at a rate more than 10 times that of corrugated containers, for example, making compositional specification a crucial precondition for determining MSW decay rates.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

(A) inviolable

(B) innocuous

(C) undifferentiated

(D) ubiquitous

C

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3.19	4b54bbf0	In the 2010s, the price of pop music cassette tapes from the 1980s and 1990s rose dramatically, which had the counterintuitive effect of _____ demand: buyers who hadn't previously wanted to purchase vintage cassettes thronged the market, believing prices would continue to rise and the tapes could be resold later at a profit. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. exploiting B. monetizing C. appraising D. engendering	D
3.20	a5e747f0	Despite how _____ they may seem on first glance, the works of the philosopher Georg Hegel have proven to be quite influential. Readers who manage to penetrate Hegel's frustratingly dense prose often find that his thrillingly original and profound ideas wind up shaping their own thinking. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. authoritative B. opaque C. empirical D. facile	B
3.21	bbb77c84	Containing over 160 billion base pairs of DNA resulting from polyploidy (whole genome duplication) and accumulation of noncoding DNA without significant deletion, the genome of <i>Tmesipteris oblancoolata</i> (New Caledonian fork fern) is the largest known among eukaryotes—and, given the high biological costs of extremely large genomes, is unlikely to be _____. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. protracted B. superseded C. curtailed D. obviated	B
3.22	10c236ce	Text corpora such as the Bank of English are enormous collections of electronically stored texts that can be used for empirical testing of hypotheses regarding the frequency of typical word usage. If one has a _____ that the word "get" has a high incidence in English, for example, an analysis of a corpus can support that hypothesis by showing that "get" is the fifth most commonly used verb. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. recognition B. scheme C. supposition D. synopsis	C
3.23	5a97d9cd	In a study of residential mobility in Washington, DC, LaTanya Brown-Robertson et al. found that increases in household spending power (via tax credits) had mixed effects on mobility decisions, possibly because residential location choices are not fully reducible to economic factors but are also _____ noneconomic factors such as access to strong local social networks. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase? A. transposed with B. mediated by C. decoupled from D. antecedent to	B

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3.24 6c086e70

Businesses typically try to promote themselves, but research by Michael Luca, Abhishek Nagaraj, and Gauri Subramani suggests that some do not _____ their marketing. The researchers studied restaurants in Texas and found that those listed on a popular review website (which can be done at no cost) had revenue increases of 5 percent on average, but 33 percent of restaurants studied never listed on the site.

B

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A. adorn
- B. optimize
- C. endorse
- D. counteract

3.25 83fd3cf4

Despite stated claims of global relevance, much major research on income inequality performed in the 2010s suffered from a myopic focus on a few countries in North America and Western Europe, partly due to limited data availability. Researchers would later _____ this shortcoming after gaining new access to banking records located in nations in Africa, such as Tunisia, and Eastern Europe, such as Hungary.

C

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A. presuppose
- B. categorize
- C. mitigate
- D. validate